thamesmead focus

summer '94

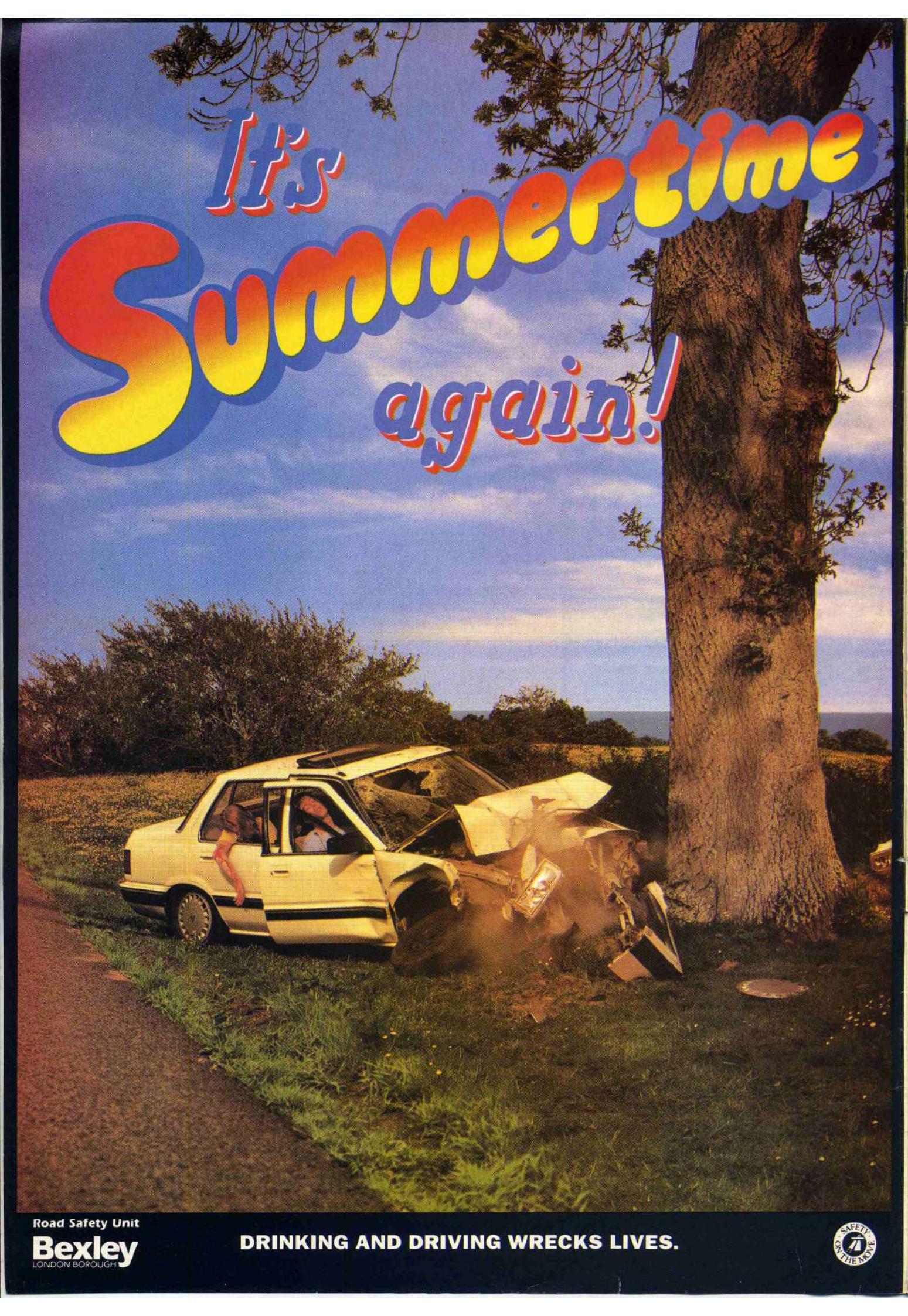




Hunter: success in gutter & drainpipe

Lessons for life: TCC works for a bright future

New chief executive : who did the board choose?


It's Summertime again!
Road Safety Unit
Bexley
LONDON BOROUGH
DRINKING AND DRIVING WRECKS LIVES.
SAFETY ON THE MOVE

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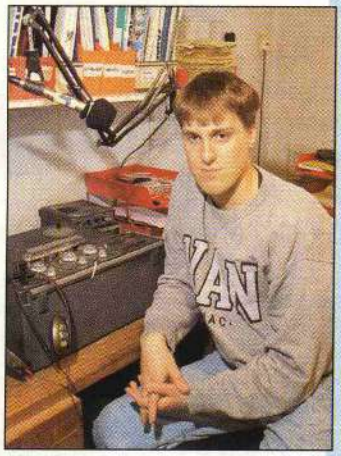
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thamesmead focus



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5 Sir George Young visits Thamesmead

Briefly

• The Board of Thamesmead Town held its 100th board meeting on 13th July.

•Thamesmead resident Fred Orford, 74, collected £686 in sponsorship money raised from running the London Marathon. The money has been given to Lakeside Health Centre who will put it towards buying nebulisers for asthma machines and ten machines for the relief of chronic pain. Both types of machine will be loaned to the centre's patients.

•The Thamesmead Advisory Forum Family Fun Day held on 23 July was a great success. The crowd were entertained by Falconry and Magic displays and many other side-shows. The work of TAF and details of how to get involved will be featured in full in the next issue of Focus.

•The Clothing Project recently celebrated its first birthday. Set on Tavy Bridge, the project sells quality second-hand clothes and raises money for Thamesmead charities. Please take any donations of clothes to the shop which is open every week day except Thursday from 10am-1pm and 2pm-4.30pm.

Chief executive appointed

The Board of Thamesmead Town have appointed a new chief executive for the company. Gregory Lomax will start in his new position on 5 September.

Lomax is currently the Housing Corporation's Deputy Chief Executive (Operations), and is responsible for the corporation's £1.7 billion annual budget. He has also been Chief Executive of the Church Housing Association.



Gregory Lomax

Lomax said 'Thamesmead has an exciting future and I am delighted to be given the opportunity to take the company forward.

'In particular I look forward to progressing plans to bring new housing developments to Thamesmead and to expand the town centre with retail and leisure facilities.'

Born in Manchester, Lomax is 47 years old and married with two children.

High praise for visitors centre

The Thamesmead Visitors Centre, off Bentham Road, has received a Civic Trust Commendation.

The centre, which was built by Trust Thamesmead, overlooks Thamesmead's Ecology Park. It provides a workshop and meeting space for community use.

The Civic Trust awards are geared towards recognising excellence in environmental design.

Community groups interested in using the centre should contact Mary Chambers on 311 4470.

Time for a bite

At last the fishing season has begun and Thamesmead's keen fishermen and women are to be seen daily fishing on the area's picturesque lakes.

The cover shot shows Thamesmead residents Bob Chapman, Cyril Mallabone and dog Jessica hard at play on Southmere Lake.



Site work started in mid July for the building of a new doctor's and dentist's surgery in Goosander Way, Thamesmead.

Designed by architect Steven Alexander, the complex will initially accommodate the doctor's practice currently in Whinchat Road and award-winning dentist Vijay Vathani will also have a practice there. The building's capacity, however, is for three doctors and three dentists, and these places will be filled as demand grows.

The building has full disabled access and will have facilities for minor surgery to be carried out.

Parking will be shared with the village hall currently being built for the adjacent site. The surgeries are expected to be complete by the spring of 1995.

The village hall (shown above) is being built for Thamesmead Town and will be for use by the community.



Lord Wade of Chorlton recently visited Thamesmead.

Lord Wade, (left) who is President of the Combined Heat and Power Association, had a meeting with Thamesmead Town Chairman Sir James Mellon (right) and visited the Thamesmead Energy Centre.

Sir George Young visits Thamesmead

Government minister Sir George Young visited Thamesmead in July, when he was given a tour of the Energy Centre and the area's undeveloped land. The visit was rounded up with a lunch at the Thamesmead Town offices.

Brian Morrison, Thamesmead Town Head of Development, told Sir George that the Western Thamesmead site visited was the first to be identified as suitable for a sustainable development.

He explained that the company is looking for a partnership between the local authority (London Borough of Greenwich) and the private sector to invest in developing the area in a scheme which would build up to 3,000 new homes and create many local jobs.



Brian Morrison (left), David Evennett MP for Bexley (centre) and Sir George on the undeveloped land site

Morrison said that substantial funds would be required but that the holistic approach of the development would benefit the community and investors alike.

Also present at the lunch were Thamesmead Town Chairman, Sir James Mellon; David Evennett, MP; John Sienkiwicz, the Department of the Environment's Head of the London Development Unit; members of the Thamesmead Town Board and key members of staff.

New Euro rep elected

In June this year, Labour's Shaun Spiers was elected Member of the European Parliament for the constituency which covers Thamesmead. Spiers replaced the sitting MEP, Peter Price (Conservative).

Shortly after winning the European seat, Spiers visited Thamesmead, touring the area and going to the Thamesmead Town company offices.

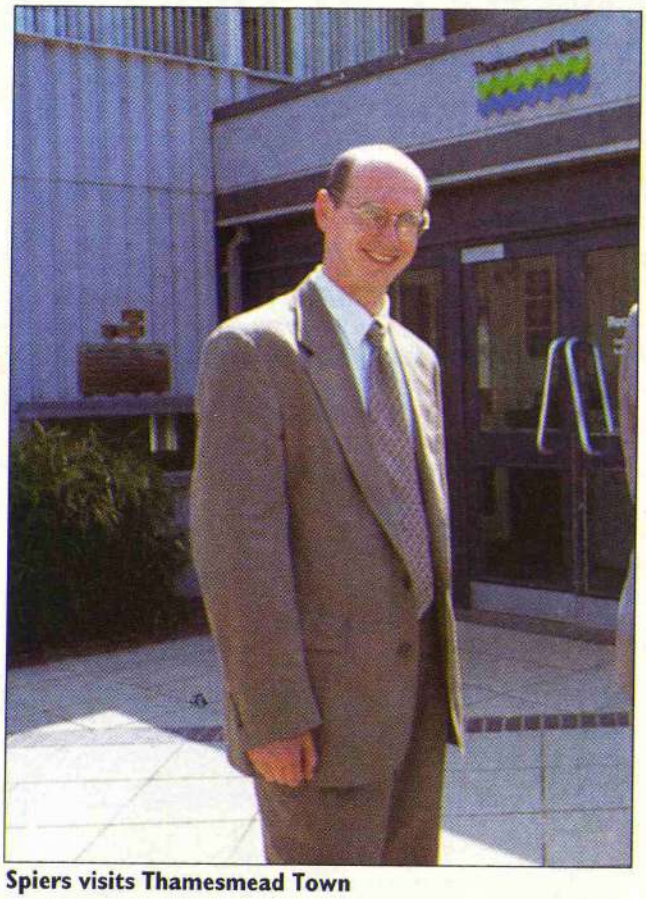
Until now Spiers has been working as Political Officer of the Co-operative Wholesale Society in Woolwich. He is 32 years old and has been a member of the Labour Party for eight years.

This will be his first time as an MEP. How does the new MEP find the job?

'Hectic,' says Spiers, 'Because my constituency is so large (it spans nine UK Parliamentary seats) I have a huge amount of correspondence to deal with and have to gen up on a lot of technical issues.'

Spiers will work closely with Labour colleagues on Greenwich and Bexley Borough Councils and will liaise with the Waterfront project, which is geared towards revitalising the part of the Thames which runs along Greenwich.

He will also continue the campaign started by Price to achieve a regional grant for the South East Thames Corridor. Although the first bid was turned down, Spiers hopes to make a successful bid in 1996.



Spiers visits Thamesmead Town

BEXLEY COLLEGE

TOWER ROAD BELVEDERE KENT DA17 6JA

Climb the Hill ...

... to one of our three prime sites in Belvedere or Abbey Wood for South East London's widest choice of academic courses and skills training programmes. Study or train full-time, part-time, day release or evenings only ... and age is no bar: half our students are adults!

Get to the Top ...

... of your chosen craft or profession, be it Art or Welding, Afro Hairdressing or Word Processing. Take traditional examinations or National Vocation Qualifications - or entry to the professions. Or a Teacher/Trainer Award, enabling you to pass on your skills to others. And, of course, there are opportunities to progress to University Degree courses in an increasing range of subject areas.

Skills for work

Become qualified in the Building trade. If you are unemployed, it is ***FREE!***

Use this opportunity, train for a new career and achieve a recognised qualification in one of the following:

CARPENTRY & JOINERY
BRICKLAYING
PAINTING & DECORATING

Train for just 16 hours a week

New Opportunities for Women ...

EUROPEAN SOCIAL FUND

a 10 week course designed to develop the skills and confidence of women wishing to return to employment after a period of time at home. Bexley College offers 'tasters' of a variety of occupational areas including: **Carpentry & Joinery...Computing...Community Care...Hairdressing...Motor Vehicle...Office Skills...Painting & Decorating...Plumbing... Art & Design...Media...Communications etc.** *Participants will have the opportunity to study for RSA CLAIT, and spend a week with a local company on work experience.*

PERFORMING ARTS

1 YEAR FOUNDATION COURSE

- Acting and Theatre Performance
- Dance and Movement
- Stage Design
- TV Studio Work
- Practical Training

If you are leaving school or wish to return to full-time education and are interested in the Performing Arts this course could be for you!

For further details of these and other courses too numerous to mention, please contact our Guidance and Admissions Centre between 9.00am-5.00pm.

Tel: 0322 442331

An associate College of

the **UNIVERSITY** *of* **GREENWICH**

ENROLMENT: MON-WED 5 - 7 SEPTEMBER 1994
10am - 4pm and 6pm - 8.30pm

Whatever your education or training needs, Bexley College is here to help. We positively seek to meet and satisfy the education, training and social aspirations of all the people of Bexley.

Attention Lone Parents

On 23 August there will be an open day for lone parents offering specialist advice on the subjects of affordable child care, employment, benefits, business startup and further education.

'Stepping Stones for Lone Parents' will be held from 10am-4pm at the Thamesmead Town company offices. There is no entry fee. The day is organised by Woolwich Arsenal and Greenwich Employment Service centres.

Blooming rush

Gardens in Thamesmead are showing obvious signs of gearing up to this year's Thamesmead in Bloom competition.

Green fingered Thamesmeadians are frantically digging, manuring and trimming to prepare for the judging, which is already under way. Budding horticulturalists who entered the competition will be honoured at a gala presentation evening at the Thamesmead Town premises in September.



Pots of food at the end of Rainbow Days



Rainbow Days, a multi-cultural extravaganza held to celebrate the diversity of the world's cultures, was as lively as it promised to be.

The event, organised by the Reverend Chris Byers, Thamesmead Town, and the Thamesmead Race Equality Forum, spanned two days.

On the first day there was a workshop and show given by international dance troupe, Adzido, pictured here in full regalia.

On the evening of the second day an enthusiastic crowd tucked into food from around the world, were entertained by local Irish dancers and rounded off the party with a roaring singsong of English and American old time songs.

Acorn starts on Glimpsing Green

The former Glimpsing Green One O'Clock club has changed name and policy.

The club, which has been renamed the Acorn Playgroup, will now have sessions when parents can leave children between three and five years. This will enable mums and dads to go shopping or relax for a while on their own.

The sessions will be held on Monday and Tuesday at 9.30-12.00am (children only) 1.00-3.30 (parent and toddler). On Wednesday, Thursday and Friday the sessions are reversed with parents attending at the morning sessions.

Acorn will be opening on 5 September 1994. The playgroup will cost £1.90 per child for each two and a half hour session. The parent and toddler sessions cost £1.00 a week for each household/family (only 20p a day if you attend every day). For more information ring 310-1500 ext 451.



Marie Hills, winner of the 1994 RTM/ Thamesmead Community Club Karaoke Challenge.

Marie sings in a Country and Western style and has a voice reminiscent of Patsy Kline.

On this occasion, held at the Pyramid Club on Tavy Bridge, she won the grand prize of £250.

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BEXLEY COLLEGE

Bexley - The College with a future



Mr George Wade, Chair of Governors of Bexley College, signs the Article of Association, watched by Mrs O Bond, Chair of Governors of Abbey Wood School.

From its incorporation on 1 April 1993 Bexley College has made substantial moves forward in developing its twin aims of quality and partnership.

A recent and exciting development is the newly established link between Bexley College and Abbey Wood Secondary School in the Borough of Greenwich.

An Article of Association which was signed at the College provides for the two institutions to work together to ensure that pupils leaving Abbey Wood at 16 will be guaranteed a place at Bexley College, subject to normal entry requirements.

The College has approximately 6000 full and part-time students and has established a reputation for excellence in many subject areas.

A Constructive Year Ahead

The School of Professional Building and Surveying offers a Higher National Diploma in Building Studies, through its associations with the University of Greenwich.

In October the new sessions will commence for both first and second year HND students, who will be the first to be able to use the new HE student's common room being constructed at the Tower Road Campus.

Building craft studies are now offered in all modes of attendance.

Sweet Smell of Success

Aromatherapy, Body Massage and Afro Hairdressing are among the many subjects taught by the School of Hair and Beauty in its professionally equipped salons. Examinations and qualifications include BTEC National Diploma in Beauty Therapy and a Hairdressing Foundation Certificate. Students regularly feature in the prize lists of national and regional competitions.

Take a Letter...

Or an examination in one of the many subjects offered by the School of Secretarial Studies. Of particular interest are Private Secretarial, Secretarial Linguist and NVQ Level Three in Business Administration.

No Longer an Island

Now that Britain is a member of the European Community, connections made with our neighbours across the channel are more important than ever before. Bexley College has very well established links with educational institutions in France, Spain and Germany.

Computing all the Year Round

The School of Computing offers BTEC, City & Guilds and RSA Certificates and Diplomas, full and part-time, as well as evening courses in the popular 'C' programming language.

Help is at Hand

Help with literacy and numeracy skills is available any enrolled college student through communications workshops.

Something for All

There's something for everybody at Bexley College: for young people starting a career, those already in employment requiring a skills upgrade, and long term unemployed or other changing direction in mid career.

There is a comprehensive range of Adult Education courses at various College sites across the Borough providing, where possible, opportunities to progress to qualifications to match individual needs.

What Others Say

"The way in which plumbing is offered at your College is second to none in the (London) region. With 30 plumbing centres in the region this is obviously due to the dedicated plumbing team and those working with them."

CITY & GUILDS INSTITUTE ASSESSOR'S REPORT

"The students' business plans that I have seen today are better than 80% of all real business plans that are brought to me."

LOCAL BANK MANAGER viewing BTEC Business and Finance students' projects.

MISSION STATEMENT

Bexley College seeks to meet and satisfy the educational, training, social needs and aspirations of the people of Bexley. Currently, the needs of Industry and Commerce within and beyond the catchment area of the College will be addressed. Bexley College will positively develop and enhance its systems, facilities and teaching delivery methods in order that the needs of its various clients are met satisfactorily.

BEXLEY COLLEGE
Tower Road Belvedere DA17

Courses for 1994/5

The following is an outline of the courses available for the coming year.

Art, Design & Fashion
Building Crafts
Business Studies
Cookery
Communications
Computing
Education
Electronics/Telecommunications
Fabrication & Welding
Hairdressing & Beauty Therapy
Health & Community Care
Leisure & Travel Services
Management & Banking
Motor Vehicle Engineering
Professional Building/Surveying
Secretarial

Full details may be obtained by phone or post from
Bexley College GUIDANCE & ADMISSIONS UNIT
on **0322 442331**

ENROLMENT 1994/95

Monday 5 to Wednesday 7 September 1994

Or cut our and return the enquiry form (No stamp required)

To: Bexley College, Guidance & Admissions, FREEPOST, Tower Road, Belvedere, Kent DA17 5BR.

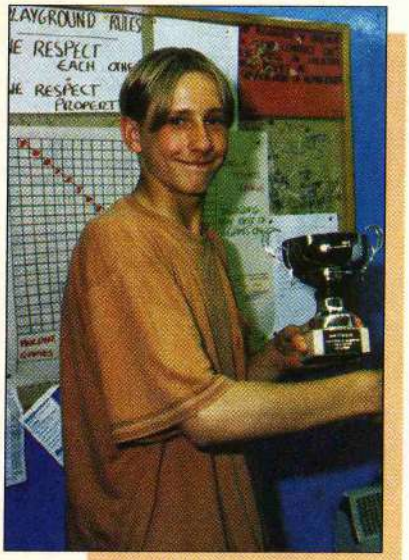
Please send details of your courses for 1994 to:

NAME _____

ADDRESS _____

_____ POSTCODE: _____

Subject of interest _____ Full/Part time: _____



Thamesmead resident Danny Eldridge, 15, who won the Southmere Adventure Playground's table tennis championship. He has beaten everyone at the playground, including all the adults.

Danny excels in all sports, but his dream is to follow in the footsteps of his grandfather, Charlie Bumstead, who was goalkeeper for Millwall and Crystal Palace.

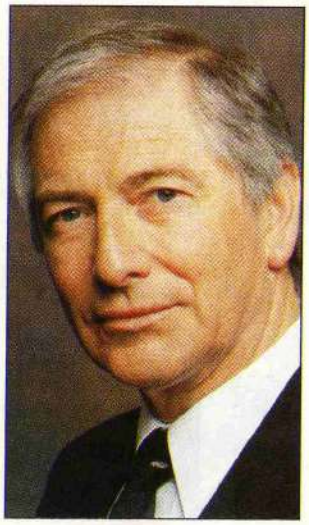
Throwing light on Watts

Earlier this year the Board of Thamesmead Town decided to appoint three non-executive directors from business backgrounds to give advice and guidance from an objective viewpoint. In this issue we profile Ted Watts, who was chosen as one of these directors.

The son of a builder, Ted Watts was born in Silvertown, East London. As a young man, he and his wife started a business in nearby Lee, buying property and doing it up on behalf of housing associations.

The business grew rapidly, developing into a surveying, architecture and engineering consultancy.

Today, Watts and Partners has offices in Haymarket, Central London; Glasgow; Manchester; Bristol and Blackheath.



One of Watts' proudest achievements is the setting up of the Hyde Housing Association, which has since become an amalgamation of some half a dozen HAs.

As the founder chairman, Watts set up the association with a group of friends. The idea was to provide needy people with housing. 'I wouldn't say it got out of hand,' laughs Watts, 'but the thing grew. We started meaning to provide four homes a year, and now Hyde is enormous.'

Watts takes little credit for his success, in both the business and community areas. 'My forté is getting together good teams,' he says. 'Anything I've ever done has always been down to team work'.

Watts says that he is aware of just what he should and should not get involved with at Thamesmead. 'And when I'm not needed any more,' he says, 'I'll understand that and go, without being phased.'

Watts is clear as to his priorities in his new post. 'I am prepared to say what I think in a non-aggressive and upfront manner. I believe that, in the end, we have to satisfy the people that matter, the customers.'

Thamesmead Town

GRANTS FROM THAMESMEAD TOWN

Thamesmead Town invites voluntary organisations, community groups and other bodies who work for the good of the Thamesmead community to apply for a grant. The maximum award is limited to £3,000. If you think your organisation is likely to qualify, please complete and return the coupon as soon as possible to receive an application form and further details.

CLOSING DATE FOR COMPLETED APPLICATION FORM: 14 September 1994

Failure to meet this date may result in your application form not being considered.

Name of organisation:.....

Address:.....

.....

Name of Representative:.....

Position held:.....

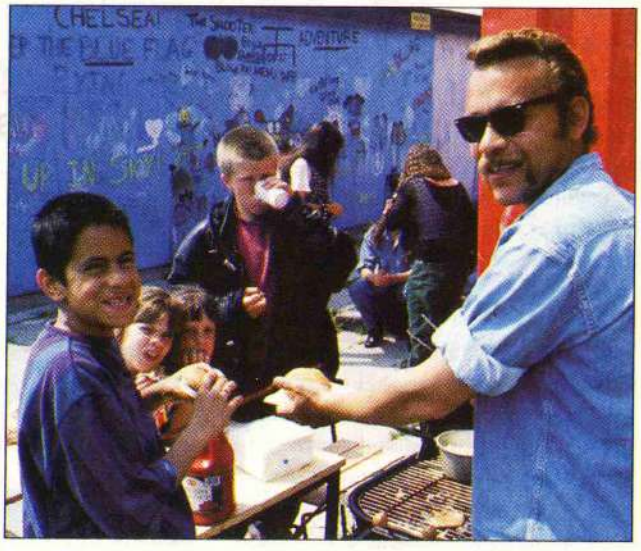
I would like to receive further information about grants which may be available from Thamesmead Town.

Please send details to:.....

.....

Signed:.....Date:.....

Cut out this coupon and send it to: **The Directors Support Unit, Thamesmead Town, Harrow Manor Way, Thamesmead South, London, SE2 9XH.** If you require further details please telephone Miss S Bell on **081-310 1500 ext392.**



Southmere Adventure Playground decided to hold a Christmas party...in the middle of summer! Shown celebrating is playleader Johnny Johnson and members of the youth club.

Celebration, Inspection and Vision

Thamesmead Community College's fête, held to celebrate 25 years in existence and one year as a community college, honoured the past, but the college is largely focused on the future.

Until one year ago, Thamesmead Community College was called Riverside school. Since becoming a community college, while it continues to provide education for pupils between 11 and 18 years old, it has increasingly aimed at higher standards and broadening its scope to reach people of all ages.

Last month the school underwent every teacher's nightmare – the dreaded Office for Standards in Education (Ofsted) inspection.

Every four years, all schools are subject to an intensive inspection by Ofsted, which can literally 'make or break' a school – the knock-on effect of a negative report could even lead to a school shutting down.

In the event, the contents of the report were something of a relief. Although there were some directions to improve various aspects of the college, the inspectors endorsed the college's 'vision' as set out in its development plan devised by TCC's principal, John Sherbourne and his staff. The plan's emphasis is on increasing literacy, making studies more vocationally-orientated and improving pastoral and academic provision. It is written in the style of a business development plan, and talks of 'success criteria', deadlines and responsibilities.

Sherbourne has reason to be pleased. Just a few years ago the school was struggling and he has had to work hard to pull up the academic and vocational grounding the college provides. Not only this, but he is working towards making the college more accessible to the community as a whole, pointing out that the school has excellent facilities, which should not be wasted.

Sherbourne and his staff have given TCC a much needed new drive and direction which is just beginning to pay off.

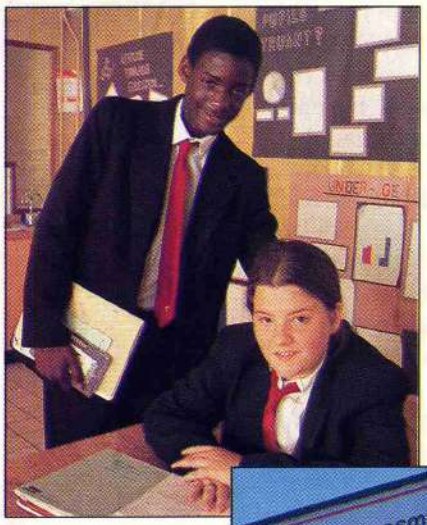
GCSE results at the school have improved on a year-to-year basis, and all pupils undergoing the college's vocational training are given a chance to become involved in places of work.

Ofsted inspectors are not known for pulling their punches, and their report on TCC stated that the college needed to further develop its assessment of pupils and provide a daily act of worship. The report's support for TCC's development plan, however, showed Sherbourne that he was working along the right lines.

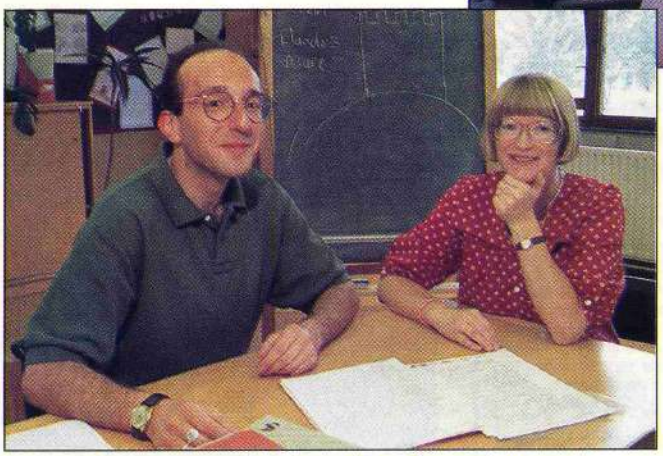
As part of the college's more business like approach, it has appointed a business manager. Linda Foden manages the college's finances, PR, premises and non-teaching personnel. She hopes to give the college a higher profile and put the message across that the college is not only for school-age pupils, but for anyone wishing to improve their education.

An example of the more open approach to the community is a plan to set up a reading club for people above school age who still feel a need to improve their literacy skills. The club will be held at a reading centre which TCC will open in September. Funded by the London Borough of Bexley, the centre will be available for TCC pupils and others from around the borough. Jane Barnes, TCC's vice principal in charge of curriculum, says that the centre's computer-based techniques can teach at any level and will make the process more enjoyable for students.

Barnes is also responsible for the mammoth logistical task of timetabling. She has to make sure that each pupil and teacher is scheduled for a manageable day and that no pupil has to do maths all morning and something equally taxing in the afternoon.







Above: TCC students Sheryl Rayfield and Donald Mars
Opposite: John Sherbourne
Below: Mark Phillips and Jane Barnes









TCC's Fête: Tony Day in the van pulling competition, the Thamesmead Karate Club and the Baton Twirling Club displays

Barnes is excited by the college's recent commitment to General National Vocational Qualifications (GNVQs) as she believes that these are the best bet for students who wish to later find employment.

GNVQs can also be used as a grounding for further academic study.

Although the Ofsted report implied that TCC's students could be pushed still further by their teachers, certain of TCC's pupils argue that with the right amount of determination, the college is the right place to get even the highest standards of education.

Sixteen-year-old Vihntin Tran (AKA Alan) is currently studying for 'A' level Maths, Physics and Chemistry, exams which he will sit a year early. Having received excellent GCSE results, he now hopes to get a minimum of three 'B' grade passes so that he can go to University to study for a degree in actuarial science. Alan says that TCC has provided him with everything he needed for a good education.

Alan's friend, Nung Ly, is also aiming to go to university, although she's not yet sure what she wants to study. She says that the secret of academic success is to ignore other pupils who criticise hard workers and call them 'boffins', the latest school yard slang word for 'swats'.

Remarkably bright students, neither Alan nor Ly passed the Eleven Plus exam, which would have qualified them to go to local grammar schools, yet each has managed to gain a good education at TCC.

'One of the school's advantages,' says Mark Phillips, TCC vice principal, 'is that it has only 700 pupils, unlike many Inner City secondary schools, which have around 1,500 pupils.

This means that you can get to know all the children by name, and that many of the children's families know each other. This makes the environment less threatening.'

Phillips is responsible for the oversight of pupils' daily experience at the college. This includes the areas of discipline and personal welfare. He says that it is essential to be accessible to parents at all times, to deal with any problems as and when they arise. He makes a point of not only phoning parents with bad news, but also when a child has done particularly well, or has shown a remarkable improvement. Reports are not sent to parents, but given to them personally on specially-designated parents' nights, which are well attended.

With playground bullying very much in the news at the moment, does Phillips feel there is a problem at TCC? 'Ofsted commented that TCC provided a safe and orderly environment for its pupils,' he points out. 'Although bullying can occur in any school, it isn't an ongoing problem at TCC.'

Phillips believes that 'children must feel confident that bullying will be always be dealt with.' When a case of intimidation is discovered, staff talk to both parties involved, arranging a meeting with bullied and bully present.

Phillips says that in this way the situation is resolved before it gets out of hand. He also involves parents, where necessary. TCC's school nurse is a qualified councillor and is available for children to air their problems. and is situated in a discreet place, so that pupils can see her in complete confidence.

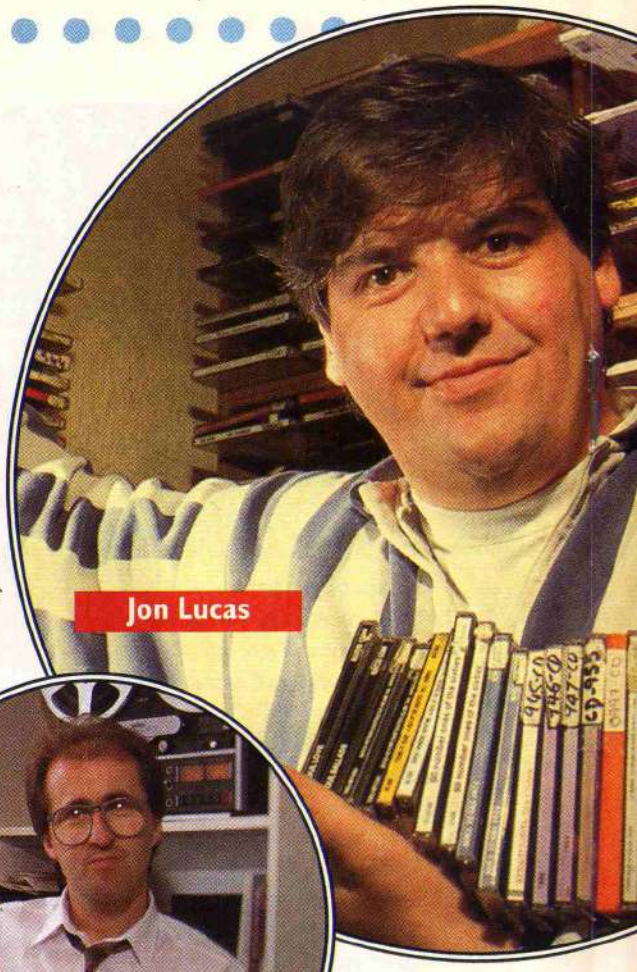
Although Phillips supports a caring attitude towards children, he is by no means a soft touch, and says that often the best way to ensure pupils' long term well being is to be tough. Pupils are encouraged to leave their problems behind at the school gate and to use the college as a safe haven from any difficulties experienced at home.

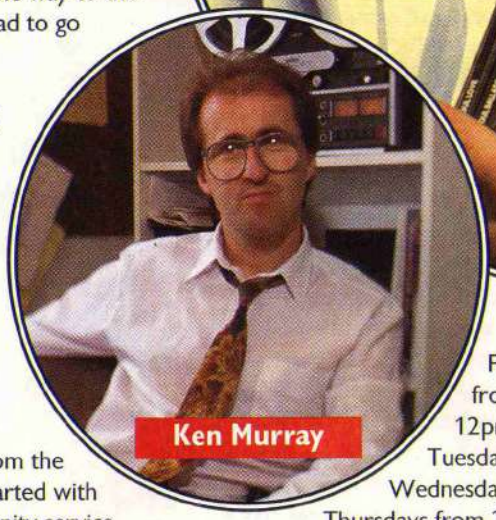
TCC's whole new ethos is centred round the idea that achievement of academic and vocational skills will ensure that pupils have the brightest possible futures.

The celebration day at the college, which included displays of riding, karate, football and van pulling was a celebration not only of the past, but of a new approach to the future.

Doubling up at RTM

RTM Radio's relatively tight budget means that presenters double up in a variety of tasks. Working at RTM may be hard work, but it's never boring...


Jon Lucas


Ken Murray

In the fiercely competitive world of local radio, broadcasting licences are hard to come by. RTM radio, which broadcasts to over 300,000 people in Thamesmead, North West Kent, Southern Essex and South East London, on 103.8FM has recently had its licence renewed for eight years.

The station was nominated in this year's CRE (Commission for Racial Equality) Media Awards and it won an award for best religious programme. It broadcasts a mixture of news, views and music. RTM is commercially run with a busy team selling advertising air space.

Hearing the smooth talking presenters on air, one could easily imagine that all they do is talk, but the reality is quite different. Here is a taster as to what some of the presenters are about.

Ken Murray, station co-ordinator Ken started at what is now RTM in the seventies, as an enthusiastic schoolboy helping out. In those days RTM was a cable station which Thamesmead residents could pick up through their television sets. The station has come a long way since then, and was first granted an FM licence in 1990.

Now older and wiser, Ken, having worked elsewhere in the interim period, has risen to station co-ordinator, which means that he deals with the day-to-day running, programming and commercial production of RTM. He also has his own show on Mondays and Tuesdays at 10pm.

On Tuesdays Ken is joined by agony aunt Val Gibson, Thamesmead's answer to Anna Raeburn, who stretches to a variety of problems, often hosting a 'specialist' in a particular field. She recently hosted well-known dog psychologist Dr Roger Mugford. Unfortunately, Dr Mugford was stuck in traffic on the way to the station, but the show had to go on so he did the entire interview from the Blackwall Tunnel, using his mobile phone.

Ruth Price, Breakfast Show With her flamboyant attire (oriental sarongs, leotards and Dr Martens) and throaty Welsh accent, Ruth is something of character. Originally from the Rhondda Valley, she started with RTM as a CSV (community service volunteer) trainee, but RTM was impressed enough with her performance to give her a joint slot with Ray Bradshaw, on the Breakfast Show.

'Working so early,' moans Ruth, 'doesn't do much for my social life'

'Working so early,' moans Ruth, 'doesn't do much for my social life. I can only go out on Saturdays, and even then I wake up automatically at 5am the next day. But it's worth it,' she adds.

The breakfast show includes music, short interviews and news updates. Ruth says that she's never been late and never made any slips on air. Well, none she's admitting to...

Jasper Blakely, trainee At the tender age of 23, Jasper is one of the youngest presenters on RTM. He is on a CSV training course but he has recently been given his own show on Friday from 10pm-12pm, and on Tuesdays, Wednesdays and Thursdays from 2pm-3pm. His show includes guests, entertainment reviews and giveaways.

How did Jasper feel the first time he hosted his own show? 'It was the most nerve-wracking thing I have ever done in my entire life. Worse than exams or my driving test.'

Unlike Ruth, Jasper admits to making lots of mistakes, but claims all radio people do. He also admits to 'cheating' on the radio. He once interviewed a tightrope walker after a show. Unfortunately the tightrope had already been taken down, so Jasper interviewed him while he walked along a rope on the floor. 'Does it feel very high up there?' he asked 'Very,' replied the walker.

At time of writing Jasper was on his way to interview wild haired and aggressively eccentric Charlie Chuck, an experience which he was somewhat dreading, given the comedian's record for shouting at interviewers.





Nigel Goodge, News RTM's black-haired news editor Nigel Goodge says that his second name means 'red-head' in Welsh, but things went wrong somewhere down the line. Nigel collates and reads all the news bulletins between 7am and 1pm and also has the final say over the contents of other news bulletins.

Using a modem (a device for sending computer language down telephone lines) Nigel is given scripts for national and international news from IRN, the news service of ITN. Local news items are produced by RTM staff. Using the IRN scripts Nigel can mix and match national and local reports. Nigel says that while many local radio stations still use pre-recorded reports from IRN, RTM's system is more flexible. If there is a major local event the IRN newsreader may cover it in only one sentence but with the RTM system the story can be fully covered by staff reporters.

Nigel is woken at 4.30 every morning by an alarm clock. 'I don't like those silly little digital ones with snooze buttons,' he says, 'I've got to have one with proper bells on it.' What do his unusual hours mean for his outside life? 'Well, I haven't seen a film for over two years. Reach your own conclusions.'

Nigel says he prefers working in radio to television because there is more autonomy, and fewer big egos. While a television journalist has to file copy past a plethora of editors, a radio presenter is 'out there on his or her own.'

Frank Depellette, Engineer

Originally from Glasgow, Frank is now a Thamesmead resident and RTM's engineer/presenter. He spends much of his time in a little room fixing equipment. He is on call 24 hours a day to repair any thing that goes wrong.

The room lies in a cellar beneath the station's former reception area on Tavy Bridge. The Butcher who used to lease the premises before RTM said that he would never want to be alone in the room because it was haunted by a World War II bomber pilot who crashed near the site. But Frank says that the ghost has never troubled him.

Frank climbed onto the roof with a piece of wire in his teeth

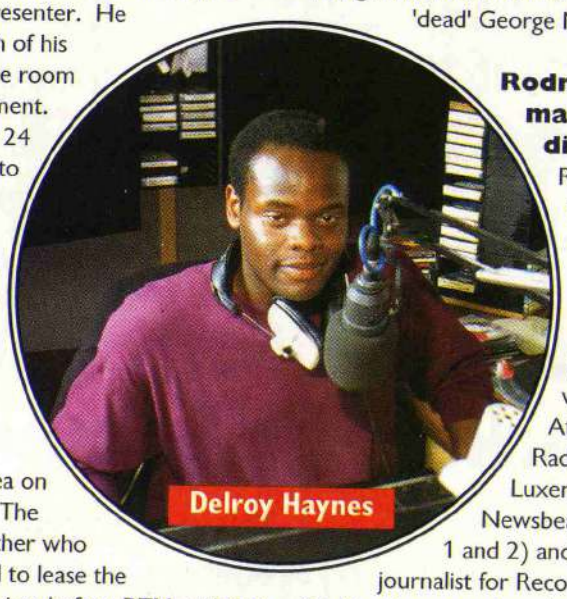
One Sunday after a rowdy night out Frank got a phone call to say that the BT lines which carry the radio signals to a transmitter in Shooters Hill had gone down. The only way to ensure that the station stayed on air was to use private transmission equipment. In the middle of the night Frank had to climb onto the roof, with a rope tied through his belt (in case he fell) and a piece of wire in his teeth.

Jon Lucas, senior presenter

Jon's popular daily 3pm show is a mixture of travel news, quizzes and music. A seasoned radio presenter, Jon used to work for BBC Radio London.

Jon had an eerie experience when he arranged to interview international soul star, George McCrae (of Rock You Baby fame) at the Lewisham Theatre. Preparing for the interview, he looked George up in a reference book on soul music. Reading that George McCrae had died in 1986, Jon checked with the publishers. Yes, they assured him, George McCrae was dead and the man at Lewisham was therefore an impostor.

Just as the story broke nationally, the 'impostor' theory was disproved and Jon got the first interview with the 'dead' George McCrae.



Rodney Collins, managing director

RTM's MD, Rodney Collins has worked for many years in the media industry. He worked on Atlantic 252, Radio Luxembourg, Newsbeat (on Radios 1 and 2) and as a journalist for Record Mirror. On his afternoon show he has received calls from people listening as far away as Whitstable, Rochester and Chelmsford.

Although the station officially claims a potential audience of around 300,000, Rodney reckons that the real amount is more like half a million. He is proud that RTM's standard is as high as a national radio station, without the large budget to back it up.

Delroy Haynes, presenter

Delroy's upbeat programmes are aimed at younger listeners, and he plays a mixture of the latest sounds.

Delroy's training at RTM has lead to him being given a much coveted slot on Radio Two.

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1 Willow Grove,
Chislehurst Kent
081-468 7142

27-31 Burnt Ash Hill
SE12
081-857 3335

177 High St.
Penge SE20
081-776 8336

26 Upper Wickham Lane
Welling, Kent
081-301 2724

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39 Manor Close, SE28
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Deekay News
42 Albert Road, DA17
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If you aren't already a Powerkey user and would like to know more, then why not visit your local London Electricity Customer Service Centre or office, or telephone 071 326 6066 or 081 298 9898

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London WC1V 6NU

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London Electricity Customer Service Centre
79 Powis Street, SE18
(Open 9.00am - 5.00pm Mon-Sat)

Kooner General Store
16 Plumstead High Street, SE18
(Open 5.30am - 10pm daily)

and

Safeway
2/6 Joyce Dawson Way, SE28
(Open 8.00am - 7.00pm Mon & Thurs,
9.00am - 7.00pm Tues & Weds,
9.00am - 8.00pm Fri,
9.00am - 6.00pm Sat, closed Sun)

* Exact opening dates not known at the time of going to press

LONDON ELECTRICITY

Abbey takes a trip down memory lane

Abbey Primary school recently celebrated its 25th birthday with a time travelling ceremony involving members of the community, children and staff past and present.

The master of ceremonies was the school's head of governors, The Reverend M Neale, who lead the audience through the history of the school, which started when Thamesmead was in its infancy.

Mr B Roach, the school's first headmaster gave a lively talk, describing what the school was like when it started in 1968 with only six children.

After a short time there were enough children to fill Mr Roach and another teacher's cars, which meant that the whole school could set off at any time on an impromptu journey. The children were racked with laughter as Roach told salutary stories about his most naughty pupils, who got their come-uppance in the end.





Abbey's children sang pop songs from the four decades which Abbey's 25 years have fallen into, and the school's star public speakers gave a potted history of current events in the period, including the death of Kennedy and Armstrong landing on the Moon.

Mrs Hough, who set up Abbey's nursery in 1973 and is still its head, described how she had not expected anyone to turn up to join the unit, but when registration day came the queue encircled the building. Abbey now has 190 pupils excluding the nursery. Abbey made its mark by, along with three other schools, piloting the Reading Recovery method, first developed in New Zealand. If a child reaches the age of six and is still struggling with reading, he or she is given individual help every day for 20 weeks. 'Improvement is immense,' says Abbey Headmaster Paul Orchard. The scheme worked so well, in fact, that a year later the Government 'jumped on the bandwagon', introducing it in many Inner London schools.



Alison Cordière, TPC's aerobics teacher

Dancing underneath the arches

The birth of the Thamesmead School of Dance was celebrated with an opening day involving student floor shows of various styles of dance.



Funded by Trust Thamesmead, with the site donated by Thamesmead Town, the school was built in one of the arches situated under Harrow Manor Way. From the outside the arch is somewhat shabby, but once inside you could be forgiven for thinking you were in a top Covent Garden studio. The studio has a professional-standard sprung floor (wooden, with springs to make it flexible for heavy landings) and wall-size mirrors. It also has changing rooms, catering facilities and full disabled access.

Classes available at the school include disco, ballet, ballroom, jazz, acting and step aerobics.

To find out more about the school contact 081-312 9372.



Nunn: innovations pay off

Hunter stalks

In common with most industrial companies, Hunter Plastics, which is based at the West Thamesmead Business Park (WTBP), got stung by the recession. Staff were laid off and debts run up. But now the company is healthy as ever and even employs more people than when the slump began.

Specialising in the manufacture of gutters and pipes, Hunter Plastics' innovative management and customer relations styles have lead to a large customer base, including DIY store Wickes.

Managing director Christopher Nunn has adopted a 'partnership sourcing' scheme whereby the customer tells the client what it wants, through a process of co-operation and research.

The *Financial Times* commented that 'Hunter was somewhat unusual in suggesting the partnership idea. In other cases of partnership sourcing the impetus has usually come from large companies buying from smaller suppliers,' but the paper went on to point out that the idea had paid off.

This innovation is one of several recently adopted by the company. Another is Hunter's part in the forming of an association for tenants of the WTBP, then named the Woolwich Industrial Estate.

Nunn says: 'For a long time the company was working in isolation. You hear these things about neighbours getting into their cars every day and not talking to each other. It was just like that. We came to work every day and had no idea what was going on next door or what the other tenants' problems were. We had little positive contact with the London Borough of Greenwich, or our landlords, Thamesmead Town.

'Unless staff know what's going on, they can't contribute'

'The catalyst for change was the City Challenge bid. The LBG had the opportunity to bid for funds from central Government. But in order to get those funds they had to demonstrate that they were working in partnership with local businesses, so they quickly went out and spoke to a few people and said "can we be partners?" Thamesmead Town became involved as well so we all ended up sitting around the same table, drinking coffee and eating biscuits together.'

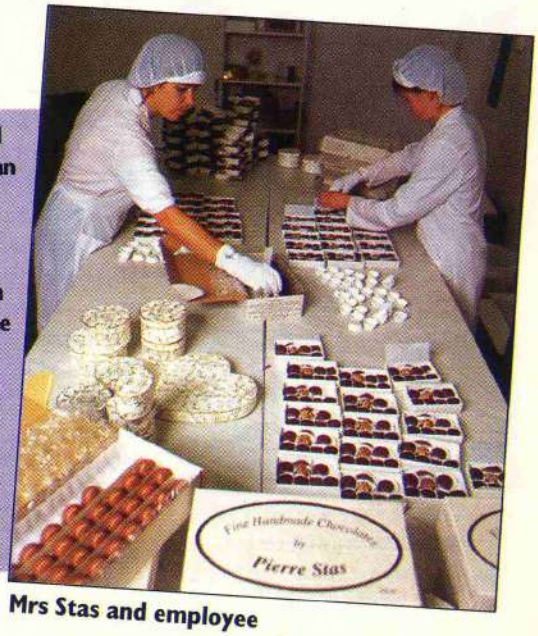
Not many companies managed to grow during the last recession but Thamesmead-based quality chocolate making and importing firm, the Stas Partnership, has done just that, even moving into larger premises.

The business was set up by Mrs Stas and her two sons in 1984 at Thamesmead's Kencot Close . It started by importing chocolates from one of Belgium's top Chocolate houses and distributing them to up-market stores, hotels and specialist chocolate shops around the South East of England. In 1988 the company took a bold step and started to make as well as import Belgian chocolates.

Using chocolate from Belgium and fresh ingredients from England Stas has created a range of chocolates for English tastes but with the high standards of the Belgian chocolate makers.

The move proved very successful and in 1993 Stas relocated to a much larger unit in Hailey road.

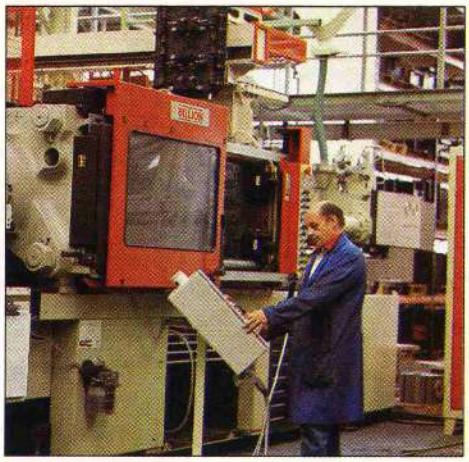
The company now competes internationally, selling to countries as far afield as Japan and Canada.



Mrs Stas and employee

s success in gutters

The City Challenge bid was, in the event, turned down by central Government. By now, however, the parties had started to talk and, says Nunn, 'Everyone felt that we couldn't just walk away from each other, that we'd started something and that we might as well see what we could salvage from the whole situation. So the tenants got together and formed an association to see if we could solve our problems on a common ground.'



The birth of the association coincided with developments at Thamesmead Town, which consequently welcomed the new association.

Nunn says: 'The whole thing gelled at the same time. The industrial tenants association was formed at the same time as there was a wind of change blowing through Thamesmead Town. Sir James Mellon came along and found that here was a body of people he could talk to, rather than individual firms, each guarding their own interests.

'Suddenly we found that we weren't being treated just as fee paying tenants any more, but as customers.'

Around this time the Government announced the Urban Partnership Fund, which again could be bid for provided that local money was contributed. The then-named Woolwich Industrial Estate Association (now the WTBPA) applied along with LBG and Thamesmead Town. This time the application was successful.

Gone are the unsightly derelict buildings, the rubbish tips and the tatty fences. Secure fences have gone up, trees have been planted, there are smart new frontages and a new pavement on the road leading to the business park. 'All these things make a difference,' says Nunn. 'It's easier to attract people to work here now.'

Nunn hopes that the association's next plan, to increase security even further, will attract more businesses into the area. 'As it is,' he says, 'crime has reduced dramatically with the measures we have taken so far.

'Another step towards modernisation is the company's commitment to the Government's Investors in People scheme, which encourages companies that are willing to spend money on developing the potential of their workforces. The company is investing in creating career opportunities for their staff. Each employee is wherever possible given the opportunity to take on greater responsibility. 'Communication is important. We don't keep secrets. Ninety-five per cent of information is available to everyone, because unless staff know what's going on, they can't contribute'.

Nunn reckons that in the future the Investors in People badge will be as important as BS5750 accreditation, which Hunter already has.

'We are prepared to train people. It's not skills we look for, but the will to work hard and progress, it's an attitude.

'Hunter also prides itself on its speed of delivery. 'We guarantee delivery of any amount of our 1,800 products within three days.

'We aim to achieve this 100 per cent but at the moment we're achieving 99.7 per cent, so we're a little disappointed.' Nunn adds, with a touch of false modesty.

'The secret of Hunter's success?'

'At the end of the day a pipe is a pipe,' answers Nunn. 'So what makes the difference is service. Our whole culture here is based on service. Not the smarmy "have a nice day" kind of service, but the genuine "these are our standards, and this is what we'll achieve for you" kind of service. And it works. Our growth has been 25% in the past two years, and that's coming out of a recession. We're bursting at the seams, and looking to acquire more space on either side of us.'

Ceejay & Co has received a Regional Selective Assistance grant. The grant, awarded by the Department of Trade and Industry, is the first of its kind to be given in the Greater London area.

RSA grants are geared towards enabling businesses to expand, but are only awarded to viable projects which the DTI considers likely to succeed.

Father and son John and Colin Rouse started the company (based on Thamesmead's Eastern Industrial Estate) six years ago. At that time the company had an annual turnover of just £2,400. Today this figure has grown to a quarter of a million and John and Colin employ 10 people. Ceejay supplies personalised clothing for a wide range of companies, including Harrods, and produces embroidered corporate badges and logos. The company relies almost wholly on recommendations.

John and Colin pride themselves on a high level of service and the personal touch.

STOP PRESS:

Film Sales, also based in Thamesmead, has now been awarded a similar grant. Film Sales specialises in non-photographic film.

contacts

All numbers 081, unless otherwise stated.

Thamesmead Town
310 1500

Plumstead Police Division
855 1212

Tiny Tots Playgroup
The Church of the Cross
Lensbury Way
(closed for school holidays except half terms)
12.30pm-2.30pm
All children must be accompanied by an adult.

Thamesmead Arts Club
Arch 9, The Arches
Harrow Manor Way
Mon & Thurs 8pm-10pm
Pottery, painting, needlework, photography. Annual membership £25.
Call 310 8543.

Fifth Abbeywood Guides
St Paul's Centre, Bentham Road
Mon 7pm-8.30pm All girls between 10 & 15 welcome
Call 437 5319 ask for Sue or 244 3488 ask for Sandy.

Bexley Volunteer Bureau
If you are interested in volunteering for charity work, Call Janet Smith 304 0911.

St John Ambulance
Manor Close Hall
Friday Evenings
Under 10s (Badgers) 6-7pm,
10-16 years (Cadets) 7-9pm
Adults 8.30-10pm.
303 8590.

Arthritis Care
Jubilee Centre
Lyton Strachey Path (off Titmuss Avenue)
Activities and general social
Everybody welcome
Every Tuesday 2pm-4pm

Epigonsia Bible Church
Greenmead Over 50s Clubroom
Lime Row
Off Northwood Place
Sunday 11am-9pm
Phone 311 8980

Directors' Surgeries

Broadwaters (Area 1)
Ray Hutchins
Heronsgate School
Ground Floor
Whinchat Road
2nd Saturday of every month
11am-12 noon

Waterfield (Area 2)
David Irons
33 Waterfield Close
Every Monday
7.15pm-9.15pm

Moorings (Area 3)
Carol Foster
Thamesmere Pools
Thamesmere Drive
On for 3 Saturdays
Off for 3 Saturdays
Call DSU on 310 1500 for details

Manorway (Area 4)
Gerry Bright
Sanderling Court
33 Goldcrest Close
Last Saturday of every month10am-12 noon

Crossway (Area 5)
Albert Devereux
7 Longworth Close
Daily 9am-8pm
Tel: 244 9323

Southmere (Area 6)
Stuart Cox
Tavy Bridge
Patch Office
Phone DSU on 310 1500

Lesnes (Area 7)
Pat Daniels
Area Patch Office
Evenlode House
Coralline Walk
1st Saturday of every month
10am-11am

Parkview (Area 8)
Katharine Galloway
32 Maran Way
1st and 3rd Saturday
10.30am-12.30pm
2nd and 4th Tuesday
4pm-6pm
Call DSU 310 1500 for details

Greenmead (Area 9)
Ilan Hathaway
Greenmead Senior Citizens' Clubroom
Lime Row
Last Saturday of every month
10am-12 noon
Thamesmere Pools

MPs' Surgeries

John Austin-Walker M.P.
First and third Friday and third Saturday 6pm at 39 Wellington Street, Woolwich. Call 317 9001 for appointment. First Saturday of each month at 11am Thamesmere Leisure Centre.

David Evennett M.P.
First and third Friday of every month from 7pm at Erith Town Hall.
Otherwise contact him at House of Commons 071-219 4132.

MIND in Bexley
303 5816.

Crossway Gym Club
Archway 11,
Byron Close
312 1190

Bexley Access Group
303 8937

St Pauls Centre
Bentham Road, Central Thamesmead
Halls, rooms and kitchens for hire
310 6814

Thamesmead Boxing Club
Poplar Place (rear of boiler house)11 year olds and over welcome
Monday, Wednesday and Friday
6.30pm-8.30pm

Parent & Toddler Group
Broadwaters Community Centre
Every Thursday
9.15am - 11.15am
Contact Lisa on 081-316 6479 or Julie on 854 0062

Thamesmead Toy Library
Manor Close Community Hall (off Crossway)
Every Wednesday morning from 9am-2pm
Toys available on loan for disabled, handicapped and sick children in Thamesmead

RTM Radio
311 3112

National Council for Divorced & Separated
St Michaels Church Hall
Abbey Wood Road
Wednesdays 8-11pm
Sandie 310 6246
Margaret 311 6096

Bubbles Parent and Toddler Group
Manor Close Hall
1-3pm Monday and Thursday

Crossway Christian Fellowship
Manor Close Hall
10am Children of four upwards
11am Mainly for adults

Thamesmead Christian Fellowship
Jubilee Centre, Lyton Strachey Path
Every Wednesday Children's Club (6-11 year olds) 6.30-7.45
Every Friday Youth Club (12-16 year olds) 7.45-9.30pm

Over 50s Social Club
Greenmead Clubroom, Lime Row
Every Monday and Thursday.
Bingo tickets on sale 7pm, eyes down 7.30pm.
Entrance 20p members, 50p non members.

Would you like your community group to be featured in Focus Contacts? Please write to the Editor, Thamesmead Focus, Thamesmead Town, Harrow Manor Way, Thamesmead South, SE2 9XH, with full details.

diary dates

Thames Barrier Visitor's Centre
Liquid Assets exhibition for children. Learn about where water comes from. Exhibition runs until 4 September
Call 081-854 1373

Boot Fair Belmarsh Prison, Western Way. 6 Aug 2pm-6pm. Food, drink and other attractions. All proceeds to mentally disabled.

Hall Place Craft Exhibition
12 Nov - 3 Dec. If you want to exhibit flower arrangements, cake decorating, spinning, silver smithing or anything similar, call Suzanne Knowles, 081-309 5977.

Thamesmead Town Show Birchmere Park, Southwood Road. September 18 11am-5.30pm Attractions include magic shows, keep fit, clowns, pearly kings and queens and much more

The Orchard, Dartford
Jo Brand
October 3 & 4
Danny La Rue
October 6 & 7
David Essex
December 7 & 8
Bookings: 0322 220000

Thamesmead Town Board meetings – open sessions and Thamesmead Advisory Forum meetings.
Call DSU on 081-310 1500 for details.

Moorings FC - 'ere we go!

By Ronald Scofield, Chairman, Moorings FC.

Thamesmead's Moorings '94 Football Club was formed after I saw a load of blokes playing football in the street where I live.

After kicking a ball with them for a while, I was amazed to discover that none of them belonged to a team. So I put the idea to them and we got going on finding out what was involved.

I wrote to different football leagues, and found out that to be in a league, you have to have a 'home' ground. This was a bit of a problem for us, as was buying equipment, which was very expensive.

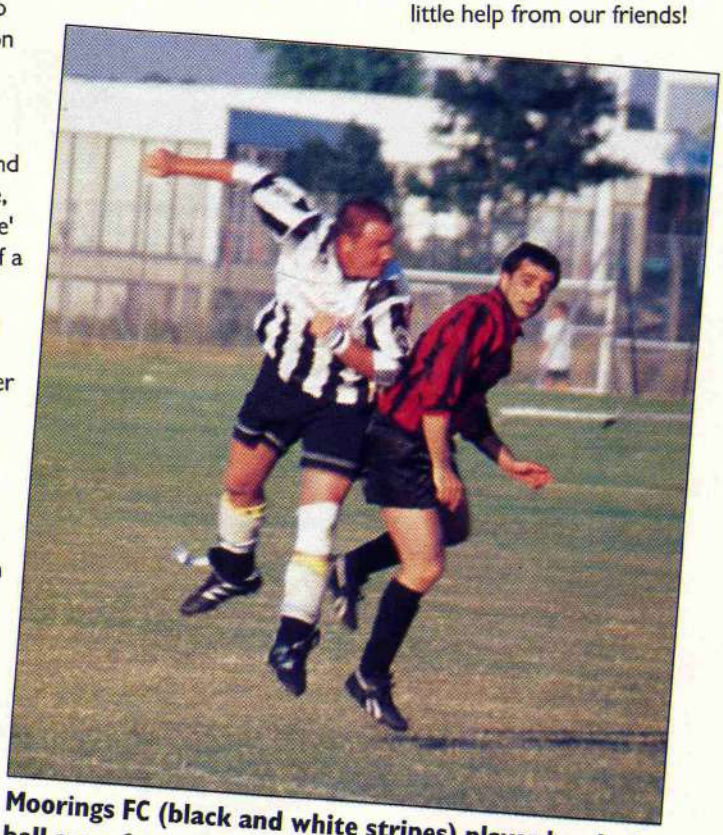
We nearly gave up after many shops had refused us sponsorship but, even though quite a few of us were out of work, we kept putting £5 a week each in the kitty and then we had two strokes of luck.

Mr Nandra, of Abbeywood Motor Spares, offered to help us, donating £300. We were overjoyed, and spent the money on a kit. Then Waterfield school (which has unbelievably good facilities) agreed to let us use their pitch as a home ground at a discount, and also let us use it twice, free of charge. We were on our way.

The Woolwich and District League accepted us and over the summer, playing eight-a-side we've only lost one game. Now we have 18 young men eagerly awaiting the start of the season.

We are willing to play any local side between now and September, so if you want a game, call me on 310 5729.

To everyone out there, I'd like to say that if you try hard enough and ask enough you will get there in the end. **We did** - with a little help from our friends!



Moorings FC (black and white stripes) player heads the ball away from a Chimera player in a tense game at the Meridian sports ground. Moorings' eight-a-side team beat Chimera 9-6.

Thamesmead Advisory Forum Boot Fair
Birchmere Park
7 August 7am-2pm
Lots of goodies to buy and stalls to browse around.
Call DSU 310 1500
See you there!

Thamesmeanies kick off to a good start

The first season of the 51 Sports & Social Club's 5-a-side team, the Thamesmeanies, finished with the team gaining a mid-table spot and a cup final place in the Invicta league.

The Club, which is made up from employees and residents of Thamesmead Town, also takes part in badminton, squash and swimming.

Anyone interested in joining the 51 Club, please contact Richard Dighton on 310 1500 extension 377.

on housing

1994 a year for improvement

By Pat Daniels , Vice Chairman of Thamesmead Town

One of the questions I get asked most regularly is 'What do you spend all our rent money on?'

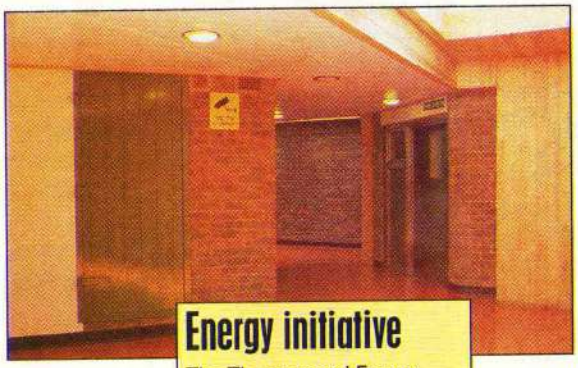
Well, when you consider that Thamesmead Town is one of the biggest private landlords in the country, with almost five thousand homes on its books, it has a lot to spend its money on.

I've attempted to let you know the sorts of projects customers of the Housing Department will benefit from this year ranging from upgrading asphalt roofs to the painting of a large number of properties. I know some of the repairs don't sound too glamourous, but they are welcome.

• Residents of Shire, Teeswater and Buckwheat Courts will welcome the installation of anti-roosting devices to stop the nuisance caused by pigeon.

• No less than nine hundred homes will be painted in areas such as Redwing Path, Wigeon Path, Galsworthy Close, Rowntree Path, Grange Crescent, Trefoil House and many more besides. Residents of these areas have been able to choose the new colours for their homes.

• The open areas at Tavy Bridge, Kale Road and Hartslock Drive are also being painted, bringing a little bit of colour into all our lives.



• Some residents will benefit from new kitchens as part of a pilot scheme. It will be followed by a major kitchen replacement in many homes next year and the year after.

• The security entry system and lift refurbishment (shown above) of blocks such as Simon Court and Harold Wilson House have been well received. And this year it is the turn of residents of Mill and Cross Courts and Octavia Way to 'get the treatment'. A start will also be made at Whinchat Road later in the year.

• Details of all of the services housing customers can expect are soon to be published in Thamesmead Town's Residents' Charter.

• Customers who are Regulated Fair Rent customers are now all able to buy the homes they live in at a discount. So if you're interested please do get in touch with the Home Owners Unit on 081-310 1500.

There are also a number of two bedroom properties available for let. To find out more call the above number and ask for Residential Lettings team.

Energy initiative

The Thamesmead Energy Centre, which is the headquarters of Thamesmead Town's mechanical and electrical engineering group is now open to the public.

Residents can call in and ask questions on how to save energy. The centre is at 30 Poplar Place, adjacent to the main boilerhouse.

Two small exhibition areas are planned within the Energy Centre and main boilerhouse, where energy efficiency measures will be demonstrated. These will include low energy lamps, boiler programmers and thermostat controls. It is a fact that 40 per cent of all central heating equipment in the UK is not used because of failure to understand operating instructions.

The exhibition will also display air circulation filters, and staff will be on hand to explain how filters can be kept clean and used to best effect.

Call 081-310 7358/9 to find out more.

Safety catches

A survey of window safety catches has begun. The survey will concentrate on Thamesmead's multi-storey blocks and be carried over the next two months.

Workers from Frankham Associates, the company conducting the survey, will each carry an identity badge and a letter of introduction from Thamesmead Town.

Any resident with a concern about safety catches should immediately contact the Technical Services section on 310 1500.

All callers will receive a visit from a technical officer within 48 hours.

VAT on domestic fuel

The Government's imposition of VAT on domestic fuel has recently caused national controversy and Thamesmead is no exception.

Thamesmead Town argued the case that the communal heating system should be exempted from this tax, as it was not an individual heating system. Unfortunately, Customs and Excise refused to comply.

For assured tenants this has meant a small increase in rent to cover the tax. In the case of regulated tenants, the company will subsidise rents to cover VAT until re-registration in late 1995. For regulated tenants who receive housing benefit, VAT may not be included in housing benefit, a situation beyond the company's control.

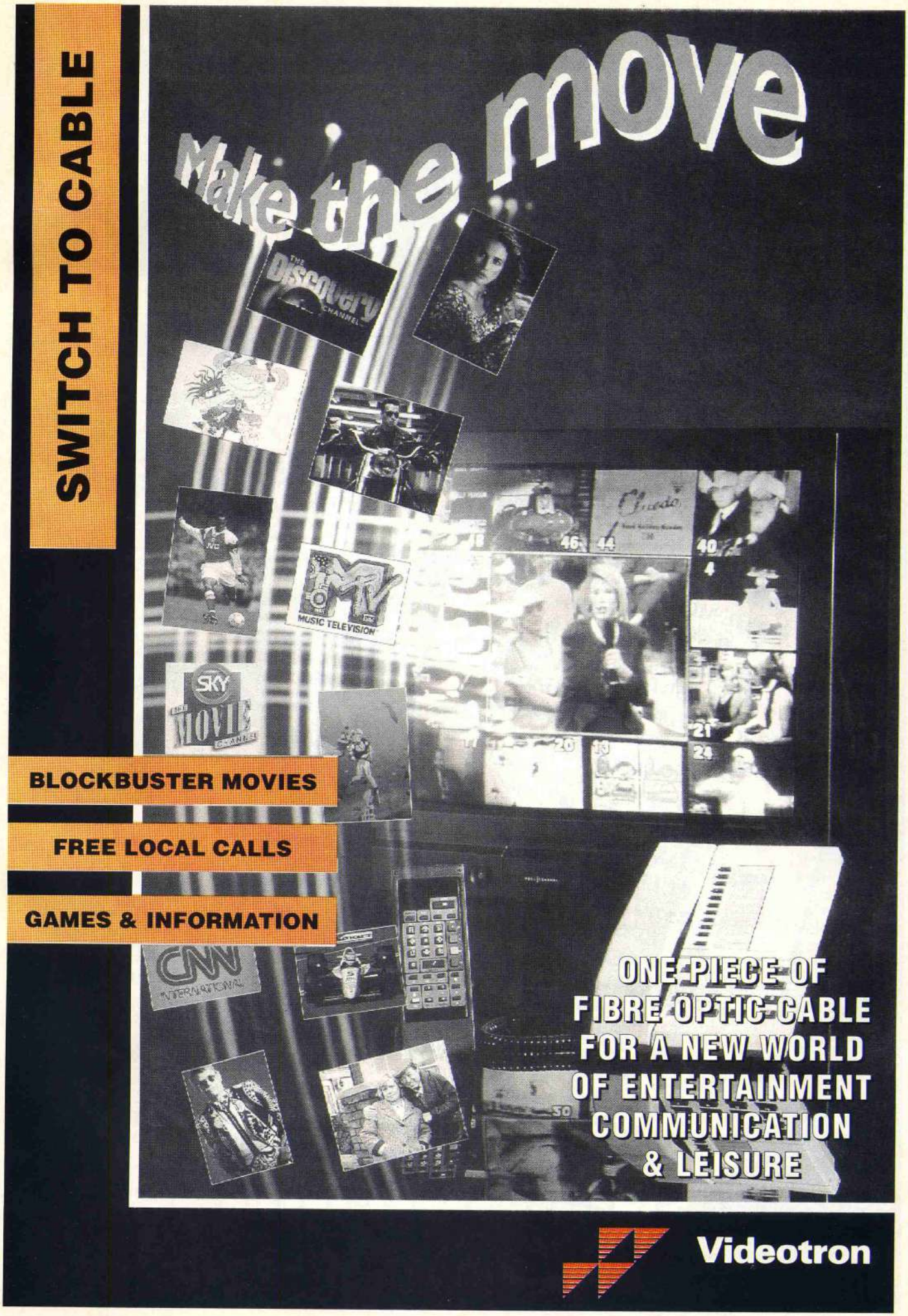
There seems to be little that anyone can do to resolve the problem, but watch this space as things unfold.

Heating review

The Board is at the early stage of considering the possibility of upgrading the District Heating System and the possibility of installing a combined heat and power plant. A recent study concluded that Thamesmead Town should consider including such a project in its long-term strategic planning.

The board is now considering the report in detail. Any upgrading of the system would give residents more control over their heating. A CHP system would use fuel to generate electricity with the heat from that process being diverted to the community heating system giving residents heat at an affordable price.

The electricity could be sold to electricity companies, producing income for Thamesmead Town. The system which would involve a substantial outlay, would be much more energy efficient, reducing exhaust emissions into the environment, making for cleaner air and a better living environment.


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